Ask before it acts

AI security · Level 2 · Lesson 4



Today we will

- Tell tools that read from tools that act.
- Choose the fewest tools a job needs.
- Explain why a person's yes must be checked in code.

Remember

- Reading tools leak at worst; acting tools can be turned against you.
- Least privilege: the fewest tools, for the shortest time.
- A person's yes, checked in code, and a log of every action.

Permission slips for robots

1. Warm-up (5 min): What can a class monitor do without asking?
2. Teach (8 min): Reading and acting tools; least privilege; a person's yes.
3. Design (15 min): Groups write a permission slip for one robot job.
4. Swap (7 min): Find unneeded tools and actions with no yes.
5. Wrap-up (5 min): Agree the class rule, then the exit ticket.

Write the eight tool cards on the board before class. No devices are needed: the robot exists only on paper.

Let’s discuss

1. Why is a tool that acts riskier than one that reads?
2. Which tool did someone grant that the job didn't need?
3. Why must the yes be checked by code, not just asked for?

Exit ticket

- Write one job for an AI helper, the only tools it needs, and who must say yes before it acts.